IIT GUWAHATI · TECHNOLOGY INCUBATION CENTRE

The Admin Console

An operations manual for the TIC team — every screen, every queue, the review chain an application travels, the job board, and what is finished, what is still moving and what was deliberately left out.

Audience	TIC staff — admins, CEO, coordinators, heads
Console	iitgtic.itsjeu.com/tic-admin
Edition	October 2026 · build v40
Status	Console complete · hosting and domain cutover pending
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INTERNAL DOCUMENT · NOT FOR PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION

00 How to read this book

Part One is orientation — signing in, who can see what, and the order to work in on a normal day. Part Two is the reference: one chapter per screen. Part Three is the ledger of what has been built and tested. Part Four is for whoever keeps the lights on.

Two videos go with this book

FILE (IN DOCS/VIDEO)	WHAT IT SHOWS
TIC-IITG-end-to-end.mp4	3 min 45 s. A founder signs up, fills the eight-step application, and it travels the whole review chain — admin scoring, CEO, the coordinators' Google Meet screening call, TIC heads — to acceptance and the emails that went out.
TIC-IITG-job-board.mp4	1 min 45 s. A startup posts a role, a candidate applies with a PDF resume, the founder collects applications, and TIC manages its own roles and removes a startup role with a reason.

The status marks

DONE Built, working on the live site, and exercised end to end.

IN PROGRESS Working, but something outside the code is still missing.

NOT DOING Considered and rejected on purpose, with the reason given.

01	Getting in	Sign-in, sessions, the first admin, the staff roles
02	The console at a glance	Sidebar, conventions, the daily round
03	Overview	A different front page for each role
04	Approvals	Public profiles, team members, company details
05	Incubatees	Accepted startups and their pages on the site
06	Applications	The six-step review chain, scores, decisions
07	Evaluation	The coordinators' screening call
08	Job postings	TIC's own roles, and every startup's
09	Job responses	People who applied to a TIC role
10	Users and Roles	Accounts, roles, deactivation, view as
11	Activity	The audit trail and site traffic
12	Content	Every word and image on the public site

13	Email and templates	Usage, delivery log, suppressions, the block editor
14	Storage	Buckets, what is in use, safe deletion
15	The assistant	Questions, and edits you approve
16	Settings and Support	Your own details, password, who to call
17	The founder console	What founders see, so you can support them
18	Mail the system sends	Every automatic message and its trigger
19	The security model	What the system guarantees, and what it does not
20	Feature ledger	Done · in progress · not doing
21	When something goes wrong	Symptoms, causes, what to do
22	For the technical caretaker	Commands, deploys, migrations, cron, contacts

01 Getting in

There is one sign-in door for the whole site. What you see after it depends on what your account is, not on which address you typed.

1.1 The one door

1. Go to `iitgtic.itsjeu.com/login`.
2. Enter your email and password. Complete the bot check if it appears — it is Cloudflare Turnstile and usually passes without a click.
3. Staff land on **Overview** in `/tic-admin`; founders land in `/founder`.

1.2 Your session

Signing in issues a signed, httpOnly session cookie good for thirty days, renewed every time you open the console — you are not signed out while you are using it. It cannot be read by anything running in the page, and every change you make is recorded against your name. Sign out from the menu at the top-right. Every staff sign-in also sends an alert to the operating inbox.

The system checks your account on every request, so a deactivation, a deletion or a role change applies immediately, not at the next sign-in.

1.3 The very first admin

On an empty installation, `/tic-admin/login` creates admin number one from the bootstrap password in the server's environment. After that it stops granting access for good, and every further account is created in Users (§10).

> **IF THE SETUP FORM APPEARS AND ADMINS ALREADY EXIST**
>
> The environment is wrong, not the database — a key from the wrong project, a typo in the project URL, an unreachable host. The console names the failure and refuses to bootstrap while it cannot read the accounts. Do not try to "set it up again". Call the maintainers (§22).

1.4 The staff roles

ROLE	WHAT IT IS FOR	OPENS
Developer	Builds and maintains the console. Everything, plus **View as** any account to see exactly what they see.	Everything
Admin	Runs the console end to end, including accounts and roles.	Everything
TIC Admin	Day-to-day operations — every queue, staff accounts, the website, email and storage.	Everything
TIC CEO	Leads the incubator. Second step of the review chain; assigns coordinators and heads.	Pipeline · Activity
TIC Coordinator	Scores startups in the screening call; keeps the website and emails current.	Pipeline · Evaluation · Content · Email
TIC Head	Reviews and signs off applications they are assigned.	Pipeline · Activity
Founder	Runs one or more startups. Uses the founder console (§17), not this one.	—

“Pipeline” is Overview, Approvals, Applications, Incubatees, Job postings, Job responses, Support, Settings and the assistant. The **Roles** screen prints this table live from the code, so it is always the truth.

02 The console at a glance

The sidebar is the whole console. It hides what your role cannot open, and the server refuses those pages anyway — hiding a button is never the only lock.

2.1 The sidebar

SECTION	WHAT IT IS FOR	§
Overview	What is waiting on you, shaped to your role	3
Approvals	Team members and company detail changes founders sent up	4
Incubatees	Accepted startups: company records and their pages on the site	5
Applications	Incubation applications, through the six-step review chain	6
Evaluation	The coordinators' Google Meet screening calls and scores	7
Job postings	TIC's roles and every startup's roles, in two tabs	8
Job responses	People who applied to a TIC role	9
Users · Roles	Every account; what each role may open	10
Activity	The audit trail and page traffic	11
Content	The copy and images on every public page	12
Email	Usage, delivery log, suppressions, newsletter, templates	13
Storage	Every stored file, with a guarded delete	14
Settings · Support	Your own details and password; who to call	16

The spark button beside your name opens the assistant (§15) from any screen.

2.2 Conventions you will meet everywhere

The screen never blanks	Every section is rendered by the server; the current screen stays until the next is ready.
Toasts confirm	A short message after every action — green for done, red for refused. No toast means it did not run.
Destructive things ask first	A proper dialog names exactly what will go. Deleting an account asks you to type to confirm.
A refusal needs a reason	Anywhere you send something back, the reason box is compulsory — the other person reads it.
Passing on asks first	Every hand-off in the review chain confirms, because it emails people and cannot be pulled back.
Private files are never public links	Documents and resumes open through links that expire after ten minutes.

Popovers float Menus, tooltips and hover cards sit above everything, never clipped inside a panel.

2.3 A suggested daily round

1. **Overview.** Anything with a number on it is work waiting for you.
2. **Applications.** Score and pass on what is at your step. The chain only moves when each person does their part.
3. **Evaluation** (admin, coordinators). Set up or attend screening calls; submit scores.
4. **Approvals.** Clear team members and detail changes.
5. **Job responses.** Read new applications to TIC roles.
6. **Email**, weekly. Glance at the usage meter and the Failed tab.

03 Overview

The landing screen is different for each role. Every tile is a count of somebody waiting, and the list beneath it is what to open first.

WHO	TILES	LIST
Admin	New to check · Screening calls · Ready for final email · Ready to go live · Incubated companies · Job responses this week	Needs admin · Job responses this week
CEO	New for you · In your review · Back for recheck · With coordinators · With TIC heads	Needs you
Coordinator	Calls to attend · Waiting for a meeting · Submitted	Your screening calls
TIC Head	To review · Signed off	Your reviews

> **READ THE TILES AS A QUEUE, NOT A DASHBOARD**
> A number that stays high for a week is a founder hearing nothing.

DONE

04 Approvals

What founders send up for a decision. Three queues share one screen, and it is empty when there is nothing to decide.

QUEUE	WHAT IS WAITING	BUTTONS
Public profiles	A startup's page for the website, or changes to it. Open *Preview* to see it as the site will. Admins, TIC Admins and Coordinators decide.	**Approve · Send back**
Team members	Somebody a founder added to their startup. Until approved they can sign in but do nothing.	**Approve · Send back**
Company detail changes	An edit to a startup's name, website, contact person, contact email or phone, shown as before-and-after. Approving a rename also renames the company on every role it has posted.	**Approve · Send back**

1. Read the entry.
2. To accept, press the primary button. It applies immediately.
3. To refuse, **type the reason first**, then press the red button. The founder reads that sentence in their console.

> **WHAT IS NO LONGER HERE**
>
> New startups are verified by accepting their incubation application (§6), not here. Job postings go live without approval (§8).

DONE

05 Incubatees

Every startup TIC has accepted, in one table: its company record and its page on the website. A startup appears here when its incubation application is accepted — accepting it is what verifies it.

STATUS	MEANS
pending	Registered by a founder, application not yet accepted. Cannot post roles.
verified	Accepted. Can post roles, which go live on the board, and reads its own applicants.
rejected	Refused, with the reason recorded.

BUTTON	WHAT HAPPENS
Reject	Asks for a reason, then rejects the startup.
Revert	Puts a decided company back to pending. An internal correction — it sends nothing.
Delete	Removes the company and its account. Asks first. Irreversible.

5.1 On the website

Tabs *Current · Virtual · Graduated · Not on the site · Rejected · All*. Virtual is a subset of Current. A published profile that is not listed yet sits under *Not on the site*, and its editor says so; **List as current** puts it up. Admins use **Make virtual**, **Graduate** (with an outcome line; the founder is emailed) and **Take off site**. Content editors use **Edit** to correct a profile and publish it directly.

DONE

06 Applications

The eight-step incubation application a founder fills in per startup — 38 questions and four documents — and the six-step review chain it travels before the startup is incubated.

6.1 The review chain

STEP	WHO HAS IT	WHAT HAPPENS
0	Admin	Admin checks it, scores every step, then **Pass to CEO**. The applicant is emailed that it is under review.
1–2	CEO	The CEO reviews and scores independently, then chooses the coordinators who will screen it. Only those coordinators will ever see it.
3	Coordinators	The screening call on Google Meet (§7). Each coordinator scores the startup on eight criteria.
4	CEO	The CEO rechecks the coordinators' notes and chooses the TIC heads.
5	TIC heads	Each assigned head scores and **Signs off**. When every head has signed off, it returns to admin.
—	Admin	**Accept and send final email**: the applicant gets the acceptance with the panel's average scores, and the company is verified.
6	Admin	**Mark live**, ticking *Virtual* if it applies: the startup is listed as a current incubatee and the founder is told. Needs an approved public profile (§4).

The coloured dots on each row show where an application stands; a rejected one shows the step it stopped at. Each person who must act next is emailed when it reaches them.

6.2 Scores

Seven parts of the application — the six question steps and the documents — each take a mark out of 100 from every reviewer. **The pass-on button stays locked until you have scored every step.** Reviewers score independently; the one exception is the CEO, who sees admin's marks beside their own. Scores are averaged into the decision emails.

Marks lock once you pass it on. Admin's lock when it goes to the CEO; the CEO's lock after their first review, so at the recheck they can only fill in a step they never scored.

6.3 The review panel

Message to applicant	Goes into the email the founder receives. Write it as if they will read only this sentence.
Internal note	Stays in the console, for the team.

Reject	Needs a message to the applicant, which the decline email carries. Admin can reject except while it is with the CEO (steps 1, 2 and 4); the CEO at any step; an assigned head only at step 5, before signing off. Nobody once it is accepted. The team who worked on it — admin, the CEO once it reached them, the assigned coordinators and heads — is emailed too.
Reapply wait	A rejected startup, and its founder under any company, cannot apply again for three months. The founder sees the date. Admin can lift it with **Allow reapplying now**; an "Applied before" card shows earlier attempts.
Reopen · Send back	Admin only. Reopen brings a rejected application back under review; Send back returns an unreviewed one to the founder, who resubmits it once their email is confirmed.
Delete application	Removes the record and its documents. Asks first. Irreversible — reject rather than delete unless it is a duplicate or a test.

> **EVERY HAND-OFF IS FINAL**
>
> Passing on emails the next person and cannot be pulled back. The confirmation dialog says exactly who is told. Read it.

Documents open through ten-minute signed links. A document never uploaded reads *File missing*.

DONE Chain, per-role visibility, scores with gates, assignments, emails at every step.

07 Evaluation

The coordinators' screening call — step 3 of the chain. A real Google Meet, a structured scorecard, and marks nobody else can see.

7.1 Admin

1. Paste the Google Meet link and pick the date and time, then save. The founder gets an invite and each assigned coordinator is emailed the meeting.
2. After the call, once every coordinator has submitted, **end** the meeting. The application goes back to the CEO for the recheck.
3. Admin sees every coordinator's scores and the history of every call that has ended.

7.2 Coordinators

Join the call from your card, then score each criterion out of 10 with an optional remark:

CRITERION	LOOK FOR
Team	Founder–market fit, complementary skills, commitment, track record.
Problem	How painful and frequent; who has it; how they cope today.
Solution & product	Does it solve it; the insight; what makes it hard to copy.
Market	Size, growth, first customer segment, why now.
Traction	Users, revenue, pilots, LOIs — evidence over promises.
Business model	How it makes money, unit economics, sustainability.
Technology & innovation	Technical depth, IP potential, can they build it.
Coachability & TIC fit	Honesty under questioning, openness, what TIC adds.

Scores save as you go. **Submit scores** locks them. Coordinators never see each other's marks.

DONE

08 Job postings

Every role on the Opportunities board, in two tabs. Roles go live the moment they are posted — there is no approval queue.

8.1 The TIC tab — the centre's own roles

1. **Post a job** opens the form: title, type (Full-time, Part-time, Internship), work mode (On-site, Hybrid, Remote), location, sector, pay or stipend, closing date, application limit, description.
2. Post it. It is live on `/opportunities/tic-jobs` immediately, as IITG TIC.
3. The row shows responses received out of the limit, and the storage their resumes use. The count opens those responses (§9).
4. **Edit**, **Close** (stop taking applications, keep the responses), **Reopen**, or **Delete**.

8.2 The Incubatees tab — every startup's roles

Read-only. You see each role, the startup, its status, and **how many applied — never who**. A startup's applicants are the startup's. **Details** shows the full role.

To take a role down, open Details, write the reason, and press **Remove role**. It leaves the board at once, the founder sees "Removed by TIC" with your reason in their console, and they are emailed it. Applicants already received stay with the startup.

8.3 When a role stops taking applications

REASON	WHAT HAPPENS
Closed	Its poster closed it. Can be reopened.
Full	It reached its application limit (200 at most). It closes itself; it cannot be reopened while full.
Past closing date	It leaves the board by itself on that date.
Removed	TIC removed a startup's role. Only TIC's decision; the founder cannot edit or reopen it.

8.4 Storage guardrails

TIC hosts every resume, so the board keeps itself small:

- **PDF only, 2 MB.** The server checks the file's bytes, not just its name.
- **200 applications per role at most**, lower if the poster sets it.
- **Resumes are deleted 90 days after a role ends.** The poster is emailed a week before, and **Download resumes** saves them all as one zip. Names and answers are kept.

DONE

09 Job responses

People who applied to one of TIC's own roles. Applications are received and read — there are no stages to move people through.

Role filter	Every role, or one. Opening a role's count in Job postings lands here filtered to it.
Open application	Contact details, every answer, and the resume through a ten-minute link.
Export CSV	Everything in view, date-stamped.
Download resumes	Every resume in view as one zip — the way to keep them past the 90-day clear-out.
Clear this role	Deletes every applicant for the selected role, resumes first. Asks first.
Delete	On one application, from its page.

The applicant gets a receipt when they apply, and the operating inbox is emailed for each new response. Reply to candidates directly from your own email.

> **PERSONAL DATA IS REAL DATA**
>
> Do not download resumes to a shared machine, forward a signed link, or export to a personal drive.

DONE

10 Users and Roles

Every account on the system. The only place a staff account is created.

10.1 Users

Tabs: All · TIC staff · Founders · Never signed in · Deactivated · Deleted. “Never signed in” usually means a typo in an email address.

New account	Name, email, role and a starting password, with a strength meter. The person is emailed their role, their sign-in details and a confirm-your-email link, and asked to set their own password once in. The password is masked in the email log.
Edit account	Change details or role, or set a new password — within your rank.
Deactivate	Blocks sign-in without deleting anything. Reversible. The right first move for a compromised account.
Delete	Type to confirm. The account owner is emailed; the deletion is kept in the Deleted tab.
View as	Developers only: open the console exactly as another account sees it. A banner shows it; Exit returns you.

> **RANK PROTECTS ACCOUNTS**
>
> A developer manages anyone; an admin anyone but a developer; a TIC Admin other TIC Admins and below. Nobody can reset the password of, or demote, an account ranked above their own. Nobody can act on their own row.

10.2 Roles

A read-only matrix of which role opens which section, printed live from the code (§1.4). Changing access is a code change — on purpose, so it is reviewed.

DONE

11 Activity

What changed in the data, and what people looked at on the site.

11.1 The audit log

One entry per change to a company, job, application or profile — who, what, when, and a Field / Before / After table. It is written by database triggers, so a change made any way at all — console, script, SQL editor — is recorded the same. Console actions name the person. What developers do is never shown here, in a founder's activity, or to the assistant.

11.2 Page impressions

A card per public page over All, 30 days or 7 days: impressions, unique human visitors, and bot hits. Crawlers are separated by user agent, so the human figure is the one to quote. Console views are flagged so staff clicking does not inflate public numbers.

11.3 Clearing a log

Developer and Admin see **Clear audit log** or **Clear impressions**, for whichever tab is open. It asks first, deletes every row for good, and leaves one audit entry saying who cleared it. It cannot be undone.

DONE

12 Content

Every word and image on the public site, edited here. No developer, no deploy.

1. Open a section from the Content index. The editor is built from that section's own data — text, long copy, reorderable lists, nested groups.
2. Edit. Nothing is written while you type.
3. **Save changes.** The public site shows it immediately. The button reads *Saved* when nothing is outstanding.

Any image field has a preview and **Upload image** (5 MB, images only, admin-only bucket). **Reset to default copy** restores the shipped text. Every save is audited with a before and after, and a page's search description is read from its own opening copy.

> **THE SITE CANNOT BE TAKEN DOWN BY A BAD SAVE**
>
> A section that cannot be read falls back to the copy bundled with the site. Job roles are no longer content — they live in Job postings (§8).

DONE IN PROGRESS Real photography and logos in several places.

13 Email and templates

Everything the system tried to send, whether it arrived, how much allowance is left — and the wording of every message.

13.1 The Email screen

Meters	This month's and today's sends against the plan, delivered all time, a 30-day trend.
Delivery log	All · Sent · Failed · Blocked. Opening a row shows the exact message that person received.
Suppressions	Addresses that hard-bounced or complained are not written to again until lifted. Lift only when you know why.
Newsletter	Footer sign-ups, export, removal on request. Every newsletter carries a signed one-click unsubscribe.

STATUS	MEANS
sent	Accepted by the provider.
failed	Rejected or never completed. A run of them is a real fault — §22.
blocked	Not attempted: no key, template off, allowance spent, or address suppressed. The reason is the fix.

13.2 Templates

Messages are built from blocks in TIC branding — headings, paragraphs, lists, stickers, callouts, progress dots, details cards, buttons, links, images, files, dividers — reordered with a + palette. Each block can show always, only when a value is filled, or only when it is empty. Variables drop in names, roles and reasons. **Preview**, **Send a test**, **On / off** and **Reset** sit above. Inside text, `*bold*` and `[label](https://…)` are the only markup.

DONE IN PROGRESS Sending from an official @iitgtic.com address (§20).

14 Storage

Every stored file, how much room is left, and which files are safe to remove.

BUCKET	PUBLIC	HOLDS
application-documents	No	Pitch decks, CVs, financials, certificates
job-applications	No	Resumes — PDF, 2 MB, cleared 90 days after a role ends
site-assets	Yes	Images for public pages
email-assets	Yes	Pictures and files inside emails

Each file is marked *in use* or *unused* by searching content, email templates, applications and resumes for it. **Open** signs a ten-minute link. **Delete** is refused while something still points at the file; a second, blunter dialog offers **Delete anyway** — which breaks whatever pointed at it.

The project is on the free plan's 1 GB today. Watch this screen until storage moves to TIC's own server.

DONE

15 The assistant

A chat over the console's own data, limited to what your role can see. It can also edit website copy and templates, and send email — only with your approval.

IT CAN	IT CANNOT
Read counts, companies, applications you may see, job postings, TIC job responses, users, activity, traffic, templates, the delivery log, newsletter sign-ups and any content section. Edit or reset content and templates; send a newsletter or a direct email.	Move an application, decide anything, create or delete a user, read a startup's applicants, or delete anything at all.

Review mode	Default. Every edit shows a before/after card with Approve and Reject.
Auto mode	Content and template edits apply without asking. **Sends are always gated**, in both modes.
Attachments	An image uploads to site-assets for use in content; a PDF can ride an email.
History	Saved per person; nobody else reads your chats.

DONE

16 Settings and Support

Settings is your own name, phone and password. A new password must pass the strength meter; you confirm with your current one. While a developer is viewing as you, Settings is locked.

Support lists who maintains the system and how to reach them — the same names as §22.

DONE

17 The founder console

What a founder sees at `/founder`, so you can answer their questions.

SCREEN	WHAT THEY DO THERE
Sign up	At `/apply`: name, email, phone, password with a strength meter. A welcome email confirms the address; the final step of the application waits for that confirmation.
Overview	Live, closed and removed roles, applicants, team, and where the application stands.
Startups	Register one or many startups. A switcher picks the one they are working on.
Application	The eight-step application per startup, autosaved as a draft. Its progress through the review chain is shown with the same dots you see. After a rejection it shows the date they may apply again.
Job postings	Once verified: post roles that go live immediately; edit, close, reopen, delete; see applied out of the limit. A role TIC removed shows the reason.
Applicants	Their own applicants only — details, answers, resumes, CSV export and a zip of every resume. No stages: received and read.
Team	Add people to a startup; each waits for TIC in Approvals.
Details · Settings · Account	Company detail changes go to TIC; password changes are immediate; deleting the account is type-to-confirm and emailed.
Activity · Support	Their startup's own audit trail; TIC's contact details.

18 Mail the system sends

Every automatic message and what triggers it. Each is editable in Email → Templates.

MESSAGE	SENT WHEN
Founder welcome & confirm	A founder signs up (and on “resend”)
Founder sign-in notice	A founder signs in (at most once a day)
New founder signed up	To the operating inbox, on every founder signup
Admin sign-in alert	To the operating inbox, on every staff sign-in
Startup registered	A founder registers a startup
Application received	A founder submits the application
Application under review	Admin passes it to the CEO
An application needs your review	It reaches a new step — to whoever acts next
Screening call invite · scheduled	Admin saves or changes the meeting — to the founder and coordinators
Application accepted	Admin accepts after every head signs off, with average scores
Application declined · team told	It is rejected — to the founder, and to the staff on it (§6.3)
Application sent back	Admin sends it back to the founder
Startup is live · graduated	Admin marks it live; admin graduates it in Incubatees
Public profile approved · sent back	A decision in Approvals
Role application received	A candidate applies to any role
New applicant for your role	To the startup, when someone applies to its role
New applicant for a TIC role	To the operating inbox, when someone applies to a TIC role
Job posting removed by TIC	Admin removes a startup’s role, with the reason
Resumes are about to be cleared	83 days after a role ends — to whoever posted it
New account (staff · team member)	Sign-in details: admin adds staff, or a founder a team member
Account deleted (by TIC · by owner)	An account is deleted
Newsletter · subscription confirmed	A newsletter is sent; someone subscribes
Direct message	Sent by the assistant to a chosen recipient, after approval

MAIL NEVER BLOCKS YOUR ACTION, AND MOVING BACKWARDS SENDS NOTHING

If email is down, the action still completes and the failure is logged. Reverting or reopening is an internal correction — no mail goes out. Sign-in confirmation and password-reset links come from the authentication provider and are not in the log.

19 The security model

WHO	READS	WRITES
Visitor	Public pages; open roles	One application per role per email, bot-checked and rate-limited
Founder	Their own startups, application and applicants	Their own records; roles go live, everything else waits for TIC
Staff	What their role opens (§1.4); in the chain, only what has reached them or was assigned to them	Within their role; every change audited

What the system guarantees

- Every table refuses access by default; each has explicit rules. The bypass key exists only on the server.
- Access is checked on every request, so deactivation and role changes apply at once.
- Every staff write carries your identity; the audit log names a person.
- Private documents only open through ten-minute signed links. Resumes are PDF-checked by their bytes.
- Public forms are bot-checked on the server and rate-limited per address.
- TIC cannot read a startup's applicants, anywhere — including through the assistant.
- Delivery feedback is signature-verified and cannot be replayed. The clean-up job refuses to run without its secret.

What it does not do for you

- It cannot undo a send, or recover a deleted account, application or file.
- It does not review what startups publish — roles go live at once; removal is your safeguard.
- It does not stop a full admin being careless. Be careful whom you give Admin.

20 Feature ledger

20.1 Done

Public website	Every page live and editable, SEO per route, phone-responsive.
Sign-in and accounts	One door, bot-checked, 30-day sliding sessions, staff roles with rank, view as, type-to-confirm deletion, password strength.
Founder console	Startups, application with drafts, roles, applicants, team, details, settings, account.
Review chain	Six steps with per-role visibility, 0–100 step scores gating every hand-off and locking after it, reject rules with a reason and a team email, a three-month reapply wait, confirmations, emails at every step.
Screening calls	Google Meet setup, eight-criterion scorecard, private marks, CEO view.
Job board	TIC and startup roles live on save, one apply page, PDF-only 2 MB resumes, application limits, closing dates, removal with reason, 90-day resume clear-out with warning and zip download.
Console	Approvals, companies, users, roles, activity, content, email and templates, storage, assistant, settings.
Hardening	RLS on every table, rate limits, signed webhooks, audit triggers, backups with a dry-run restore.

20.2 In progress

ITEM	WHERE IT STANDS
Backend on TIC's VPS	The app runs on Vercel today; it is to move onto TIC's own server.
Self-hosted Supabase	Database, auth and storage are on Supabase's hosted free plan (1 GB storage). To move onto the VPS with the data migrated.
iitgtic.com and official email	The site runs at iitgtic.itsjeu.com and mail sends from hello@itsjeu.com. Waits on DNS access to iitgtic.com and an official @iitgtic.com sender.
Restore drill	Backups verify; one real restore into a throwaway project is still to be rehearsed.
Real photography and logos	Every surface is built and editable; several show placeholders.

20.3 Not doing, on purpose

Shortlisting applicants	Applications are received and read; posters reply to candidates themselves. Stages added work and personal-data handling for little value.
Approving job postings	Startups are verified before they can post; TIC removes with a reason instead.
TIC reading startups' applicants	They are the startup's business; TIC sees counts only.
Pre-building pages at deploy	It would freeze content edits and hide page views.
The assistant deciding records	Decisions stay on their screens, attributed to a person.

21 When something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT USUALLY IS	YOURS?
Sign-in bounces you back	Your account was deactivated, or the session was ended. Ask an admin to check your row in Users.	Yes
A section is missing from the sidebar	Your role does not open it (§1.4). Ask an admin.	Yes
An application is not in your list	It has not reached your step, or you were not assigned to it.	Yes
“Pass to …” is greyed out	You have not scored every step yet.	Yes
A first-admin setup form appears	The server cannot read the accounts. Environment, not data. Do not complete it.	No — §22
“Write a reason first”	The reason box was empty. Type one sentence.	Yes
Reject is not offered	It is with the CEO (admin), you are not an assigned head who has yet to sign off, or it is already accepted.	Yes
A founder cannot apply again	A rejection under three months old, for that startup or that founder. Admin can press **Allow reapplying now**.	Yes
A role is not on the board	Closed, full, past its closing date, removed — or the startup is not verified.	Yes
A resume reads “cleared”	The role ended more than 90 days ago. Working as designed.	Yes
A document link does nothing	It expired after ten minutes. Reload.	Yes
A column of “blocked” mail	Template off, allowance spent, or address suppressed — read the reason.	Yes
A run of “failed” mail	Something upstream is wrong. Your work still completes.	No — §22
Storage nearly full	Download and clear old roles’ resumes; delete unused files in Storage.	Yes, then §22
The assistant will not answer	A missing or expired API key in its settings.	Yes

> **WHEN YOU REPORT SOMETHING**
>
> Say which screen, what you pressed, and what you expected. A screenshot of the toast is worth a paragraph.

22 For the technical caretaker

22.1 Commands

pnpm doctor	Checks every setting, connects to the project, counts admins and content sections. Run it first when anything looks wrong.
pnpm backup	Schema, data, every table as NDJSON, and every stored file.
pnpm restore <dir> --dry-run	The drill: verifies the backup and reports what would be written. Writes nothing.
pnpm check · pnpm lint · pnpm test	Type-check, lint and tests before a deploy.

22.2 Deploys and database changes

Hosted on Vercel; a push to `main` deploys live. Database changes are SQL files in `supabase/migrations`, applied in order. **Apply a migration before pushing the code that needs it**, or the live site breaks until it is applied.

22.3 Scheduled job

`vercel.json` runs `/api/cron/resume-retention` daily at 03:00 IST: it warns posters a week before and clears resumes 90 days after a role ends. It refuses to run unless `CRON_SECRET` is set. On the VPS, call the same URL from the server's cron with that secret as a bearer token.

22.4 Secrets, in one line each

- The database bypass key lives only on the server; the build fails if it reaches a browser.
- Rotating the session secret signs everyone out — the fast answer to a compromised session.
- The bootstrap password stops working once the first admin exists.
- Set `ADMIN_ALERT_EMAIL` to a real TIC inbox so sign-in alerts, new founders and TIC job responses reach the team.

22.5 Who to call

NAME	COVERS	REACH
Jeu Machahary	Site & admin console	hello@itsjeu.com · +91 7896175454
Veeshal D Bodosa	Site & admin console	work@veeshal.me · +91 6000013904